FOREIGN OFFICE, S.W.1.

21st September, 1951.

SECRET

It seems from paragraph 2 of Washington telegram No. 945 Saving of September 18th that there is some risk of the United States Government losing interest in our views about Japan's future relations with China, once we have ratified the Treaty at an early date, as they suggest, and of the United States Government then urging the Japanese Government to recognise Chiang Kai Shek in order to ease the ratification of the Treaty by the Senate.

This would of course be contrary to the essence of our settlement with Dulles, which was that relations between China and Japan should be settled by the two countries themselves after Japan had become a sovereign state on the coming into force of the Peace Treaty. In order to hold the Americans to this, it has been suggested here that we should try to withhold United Kingdom ratification until we see what happens in the United States. By thus holding ratification in temporary abeyance, it is suggested that we should make the Japanese Government at least think twice about ignoring our known views. Provided we can get through the period before the Treaty comes into force without any concession to the United States view about recognition of Chiang Kai Shek, it may well be that the sovereign Japanese Government will prefer to leave the whole matter in abeyance for some time longer, and we think it is very much in our interest that they should do so.

The General Election may of course in any case result in some delay in ratification quite apart from the foregoing considerations. We would, however, certainly not contemplate delaying ratification beyond the date on which the United States Government ratify.

I should be very grateful for your comments.

I am sending a copy of this letter to Tomlinson.

(R.H. Scott)

Sir Esler Dening, K.C.M.G., O.B.E.,
Tokyo.

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